

Derek Tyler Torrero

Software & Systems Engineer

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Professional Summary

Versatile Software & Systems Engineer with experience spanning enterprise IT, software engineering, cloud infrastructure, cybersecurity, networking, automation, and technical project management. As the primary technology resource for a nationwide organization, I design, build, secure, and maintain business-critical systems while partnering with executives, vendors, and end users. Comfortable moving between application development, cloud architecture, infrastructure administration, and strategic technology planning. Passionate about solving complex problems, improving operational efficiency, and building scalable, secure solutions.

Technical Expertise

Languages: C#, PHP, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, HTML5, CSS3

Frameworks: .NET, Angular, React, Redux, Flask, Express, Node.js

Cloud: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, VPC), Docker, Cloudflare

Enterprise: Microsoft 365, Entra ID, Exchange Online, Apple Business Essentials

Security: Microsoft Defender, Barracuda, SPF, DKIM, DMARC, DNS, SMTP, SSL/TLS, VPN

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLAlchemy

Tools: Git, GitHub, WordPress, Google Apps Script, Selenium, REST APIs

Professional Experience

Software & Systems Engineer

CottageCare | February 2023 – Present

- Serve as the primary IT professional supporting a nationwide organization across enterprise infrastructure, software engineering, networking, cybersecurity, cloud services, and end-user support.
- Administer Microsoft 365, Exchange Online, Entra ID, Microsoft Defender, and Apple Business Essentials including identity, device, licensing, authentication, and security management.
- Perform code reviews, debugging, modernization, and refactoring across PHP, .NET, Angular, JavaScript, and SQL applications.
- Develop and maintain internal business applications, APIs, automation tools, and reporting solutions supporting daily business operations.
- Manage AWS infrastructure including EC2, RDS, S3, networking, and application deployments.
- Lead DNS migrations, email authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC), Barracuda and Defender security improvements, and enterprise email troubleshooting.

- Design and enhance WordPress solutions with custom PHP, JavaScript, SEO, accessibility (WCAG), and performance improvements.
- Automate business processes using Python and Google Apps Script, eliminating repetitive tasks and improving operational efficiency.
- Lead cross-functional technical projects from planning through deployment while coordinating vendors, executives, and stakeholders.
- Produce technical documentation, disaster recovery procedures, and operational standards that improve support consistency.

Assistant Service Manager / Service Advisor

Larry H. Miller Honda | Sept 2019 – Dec 2022

Managed technician workflow for approximately 25 technicians, trained new advisors, resolved escalated customer issues, and coordinated daily operations in a high-volume service department.

Service Advisor / Technician

AutoNation | Sept 2012 – Sept 2019

Diagnosed complex mechanical issues, collaborated with technicians and sales teams, and consistently ranked among top regional performers through technical expertise and customer communication.

Selected Software Projects

SoundHaze — React • Redux • Express • SQL • AWS

Music streaming platform with authentication, authorization, and interactive media playback.

Postpix — React • Flask • SQLAlchemy • Docker • AWS

Social media platform supporting image uploads, comments, likes, follows, and scalable data relationships.

Aktiv — React • Python • Google Maps

Fitness route-planning platform featuring dynamic route generation and mapping.

Education

App Academy (2021–2023)

1,000+ hour immersive software engineering program covering object-oriented programming, algorithms, REST APIs, authentication, security, test-driven development, Agile/SCRUM, pair programming, and full-stack web development.

Recommended Certifications (In Progress / Future)

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner / Solutions Architect Associate
- Microsoft Azure or Microsoft 365 Administrator certification